

D727

Advanced Clinical in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A candidate planning a two-week second-grade unit on habitats found a colorful craft kit at a teacher store and a popular song about rainforests. The school library has 40 animal books. Following backward design, what should she do first?

- A. Identify what students should understand and be able to do by the end of the unit.
- B. Write the unit test after teaching the activities.
- C. Plan the craft and song, then write goals that match them.
- D. Check out all 40 library books to fill the unit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher already knows the goal and has written the end-of-unit performance task. What does backward design say comes next?

- A. Give the performance task now to see how students do.
- B. Rewrite the goal to match the task.
- C. Plan learning activities that prepare students for the task.
- D. Find a fun activity and add it to the start.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A fourth-grade objective reads: “Students will explain, in writing, how the author uses details to show a character’s feelings.” The class read a story about a girl who moves to a farm, and the teacher used a new document camera. Which assessment is aligned?

- A. A list of five feeling words.
- B. A multiple-choice quiz on story events.
- C. A short written response explaining which details show how the character feels and why.
- D. A drawing of the farm.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher's assessment asks students to "solve two-step word problems using addition and subtraction." Which objective is aligned with it?

- A.** "Students will write their own one-step word problems."
- B.** "Students will enjoy word problems."
- C.** "Students will add two-digit numbers."
- D.** "Students will solve two-step word problems using addition and subtraction."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

In a third-grade class on the water cycle, the teacher gives all students the same goal but lets some read a leveled text, some watch a short video, and some read the grade-level article. The school is near a river, and the class has 26 students. What is being differentiated?

- A.** Content — the materials students learn from.
- B.** Product — how students show learning.
- C.** The goal — some students learn less.
- D.** Process — how students make sense of it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher lets students show understanding of fractions by making a poster, a short video, or a written explanation, all scored with the same rubric. What is differentiated?

- A.** Process.
- B.** Content.
- C.** Product.
- D.** Nothing, because the rubric is the same.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

At the end of a lesson on rounding, 15 of 25 fifth graders answered the exit ticket correctly. The teacher's rule is: 80% or more, move on; below 80%, reteach the whole class. The lesson ran five minutes over because of a fire drill. What should the teacher do?

- A. Reteach the whole class, since 60% is below the 80% threshold.
- B. Reteach because the fire drill cut the lesson short.
- C. Move on, since 15 students is most of the class.
- D. Move on, since 25 is above 80.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants at least 80% of a class of 30 to show mastery before moving on. What is the smallest number of correct exit tickets that meets the goal?

- A. 20
- B. 24
- C. 30
- D. 6

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Several first graders in a class with a new reading rug guess words from the pictures, reading “pony” for “horse.” The class reads aloud together every day from a big book the teacher loves. What approach would most directly build decoding?

- A. Encourage students to keep using picture clues to guess.
- B. Buy more big books like the teacher's favorite.
- C. Read aloud to them more, since exposure alone builds decoding.
- D. Explicit, systematic phonics lessons with modeling, guided practice, and decodable text.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A candidate is making a first phone call to the family of a second grader in October. The student has made strong progress in reading, and the family speaks Spanish at home with an older cousin who drives a delivery truck. What should the first call look like?

- A.** Explain the student’s DIBELS ORF and CBM scores in detail.
- B.** Share a specific positive, avoid jargon, use an interpreter if needed, and ask what the family sees at home.
- C.** Wait to call until there is a problem to report.
- D.** Ask the cousin to call instead since he drives around.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

In a job interview at a school with a strong arts program, a candidate is asked for her teaching philosophy. She has a minor in music and taught summer camp. Which answer is strongest?

- A.** “I believe every lesson must be hands-on.”
- B.** “I love the arts and music.”
- C.** “I believe all children can learn.”
- D.** “I believe students learn by talking about their thinking, so I use daily partner talk, and my exit tickets rose from 60% to 85% correct.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

In the commentary for a performance assessment, a candidate writes: “I taught place value with base-ten blocks, and the students were engaged and learned a lot.” Her lessons were filmed in the school’s new media room. How should she strengthen the claim?

- A.** Say the students were very engaged.
- B.** Cite specific student work or data, such as “18 of 22 students correctly wrote 347 as 3 hundreds, 4 tens, 7 ones.”
- C.** Mention the quality of the media room recording.
- D.** Describe the base-ten block lesson in more detail.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A candidate planning a two-week second-grade unit on habitats ~~found a colorful craft kit at a teacher store and a popular song about rainforests. The school library has 40 animal books.~~ Following backward design, what should she do first?

Target word: first step of backward design **Decides:** Stage one is desired results.

A	Correct	Backward design starts from the goals.
B	Dropped element	Evidence should be planned before activities, and goals before both.
C	Inverted operation	Starts with activities and works backward to goals — the reverse order.
D	Camouflage	Answers the library detail; materials come after goals.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher already knows the goal and has written the end-of-unit performance task. What does backward design say comes next?

Target word: reverse: identify the third stage **Decides:** Stage three is learning activities.

A	Dropped element	Skips the learning experiences.
B	Inverted operation	Goals drive the task, not the other way.
C	Correct	After results and evidence come the learning experiences.
D	Adjacent category	Activities are chosen to build toward the evidence, not for fun alone.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A fourth-grade objective reads: “Students will explain, in writing, how the author uses details to show a character’s feelings.” The class read a story ~~about a girl who moves to a farm, and the teacher used a new document camera.~~ Which assessment is aligned?

Target word: aligned assessment **Decides:** The objective asks for a written explanation of how details show feelings.

A	Dropped element	Drops the explanation of how details show them.
B	Adjacent category	Measures recall of plot, not explaining author’s use of details.
C	Correct	Same skill (explain), same content (details → feelings), same mode (writing).
D	Camouflage	Answers the setting detail, not the skill.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A teacher’s assessment asks students to “solve two-step word problems using addition and subtraction.” Which objective is aligned with it?

Target word: reverse: from assessment to objective **Decides:** The objective must match the skill assessed.

A	Confusion set	Different task and lower step count.
B	Adjacent category	Not a measurable skill.
C	Dropped element	Drops the two-step word problem part.
D	Correct	Objective and assessment target the same skill and level.

5. Answer A Concept 3

In a third-grade class on the water cycle, the teacher gives all students the same goal but lets some read a leveled text, some watch a short video, and some read the grade-level article. ~~The school is near a river, and the class has 26 students.~~ What is being differentiated?

Target word: which element is differentiated **Decides:** The source material changes; the goal does not.

A	Correct	Changing the input materials is content differentiation.
B	Confusion set	Students are not showing learning differently.
C	Adjacent category	The goal stays the same; lowering it is not differentiation.
D	Inverted operation	Process is about the activities for making sense, not the source.

6. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A teacher lets students show understanding of fractions by making a poster, a short video, or a written explanation, all scored with the same rubric. What is differentiated?

Target word: reverse: identify product **Decides:** The way learning is shown varies.

A	Adjacent category	The final showing, not the sense-making activity, varies.
B	Confusion set	All students learned from the same material.
C	Correct	Choice of how to show learning, with one standard, is product differentiation.
D	Absolute language	A shared rubric keeps the goal equal; the product still varies.

7. Answer A Concept 4

At the end of a lesson on rounding, 15 of 25 fifth graders answered the exit ticket correctly. The teacher's rule is: 80% or more, move on; below 80%, reteach the whole class. ~~The lesson ran five minutes over because of a fire drill.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: decision from exit data **Decides:** $15 / 25 = 60\%$, below 80%.

A	Correct	$15 \div 25 = 0.60$; the rule calls for whole-class reteaching.
B	Camouflage	Right action, wrong reason; the data decide it.
C	Inverted operation	Reads a majority as mastery; the rule uses 80%.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses the class size, not the percentage correct.

8. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A teacher wants at least 80% of a class of 30 to show mastery before moving on. What is the smallest number of correct exit tickets that meets the goal?

Target word: solve for the count **Decides:** 80% of 30.

A	Wrong stem number	That is 80% of 25, not 30.
B	Correct	$0.80 \times 30 = 24$.
C	Absolute language	Requires everyone; the goal is at least 80%.
D	Inverted operation	That is the 20% who may miss, not the number correct.

9. Answer D Concept 5

Several first graders ~~in a class with a new reading rug~~ guess words from the pictures, reading “pony” for “horse.” The class reads aloud together every day ~~from a big book the teacher loves~~. What approach would most directly build decoding?

Target word: approach for decoding **Decides:** Beginning readers need explicit phonics.

A	Inverted operation	Reinforces the guessing that causes the error.
B	Camouflage	Answers the favorite-book detail; not a decoding method.
C	Adjacent category	Read-alouds build vocabulary and interest, not letter-sound decoding.
D	Correct	Decoding skills are taught in a planned sequence with feedback.

10. Answer B Concept 6

A candidate is making a first phone call to the family of a second grader in October. The student has made strong progress in reading, and the family speaks Spanish at home ~~with an older cousin who drives a delivery truck~~. What should the first call look like?

Target word: first family contact **Decides:** Positive, jargon-free, two-way, in a language the family uses.

A	Dropped element	Drops plain language; jargon shuts families out.
B	Correct	Early positive, clear, two-way contact builds partnership.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses best practice; the first contact should be positive.
D	Camouflage	Answers the cousin detail; the family deserves direct contact.

11. Answer D Concept 7

In a job interview ~~at a school with a strong arts program~~, a candidate is asked for her teaching philosophy. ~~She has a minor in music and taught summer camp~~. Which answer is strongest?

Target word: credible philosophy statement **Decides:** Beliefs linked to concrete practice and evidence.

A	Absolute language	Absolute claims are hard to defend and ignore the need for varied methods.
B	Camouflage	Answers the arts detail; not a teaching philosophy.
C	Dropped element	A belief with no practice or evidence.
D	Correct	Belief, practice, and evidence are linked.

12. Answer B Concept 8

In the commentary for a performance assessment, a candidate writes: “I taught place value with base-ten blocks, and the students were engaged and learned a lot.” ~~Her lessons were filmed in the school’s new media room~~. How should she strengthen the claim?

Target word: what the commentary needs **Decides:** A learning claim needs evidence from student work.

A	Dropped element	Engagement is not evidence that students learned the objective.
B	Correct	Claims about learning must be backed by evidence.
C	Camouflage	Answers the room detail, not the learning evidence.
D	Inverted operation	Describes teaching, not evidence of learning.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Backward design	Plan in three stages: identify desired results, decide what evidence will show them, then plan learning activities.	Choosing a fun activity first and fitting the goal to it.	Which planning step comes first?
2	Alignment	The objective, the instruction, and the assessment must target the same skill at the same level.	Assessing a different skill than the objective names because the task is easier to grade.	An objective and an assessment that use different verbs or content.
3	Differentiating content, process, or product	Teachers can vary what students learn from (content), how they make sense of it (process), or how they show learning (product) while keeping the goal the same.	Thinking differentiation means giving struggling students less work or an easier goal.	A change to materials, activities, or the final task — which one?
4	Using check-for-understanding data	Collect quick evidence during or at the end of a lesson and use a clear threshold to decide whether to move on, reteach the whole class, or reteach a small group.	Moving on because most students seemed to follow, without data.	An exit ticket result expressed as a count or percentage.
5	Explicit, systematic instruction for foundational skills	Early reading and math skills are taught best in a planned sequence with clear modeling, guided practice, and immediate feedback.	Assuming children will pick up phonics just by being read to.	Beginning readers who guess words from pictures.
6	Communicating with families	Family contacts should be positive early, jargon-free, specific, and two-way — inviting the family's knowledge of the child.	Contacting families only when there is a problem, or using school jargon.	Planning a first call, note, or conference with a family.
7	A teaching philosophy grounded in practice	A philosophy statement is credible when each belief is backed by a concrete classroom practice and evidence of its effect.	Writing broad beliefs ("All children can learn") with no link to what the teacher actually does.	Revising a philosophy statement or interview answer.
8	Evidence in a performance assessment commentary	Claims about student learning in a performance assessment must be supported by specific evidence from student work, video, or data.	Describing what the teacher did and assuming students learned it.	Commentary prompts asking what students learned and how you know.

Course scope (public description): Advanced Clinical provides aspiring educators with real-world classroom experience. This course emphasizes the importance of hands-on learning, offering candidates the unique opportunity to observe and participate in classroom environments under the guidance of experienced mentors. The curriculum includes demonstrating reflective practice, classroom engagement techniques, instructional strategies, and effective communication skills with students and colleagues through a pedagogical performance assessment. Through this immersive experience, candidates not only observe the daily responsibilities of a teacher, but also start to develop their own teaching style and philosophy, laying a solid foundation for their future careers in education. This course is taken immediately prior to Student Teaching I as part of an engaging and intensive clinical experience.